Ford Motor Company

November 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD:** Safety Recall 00S49: Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Windshield Wiper Module Inspection and Possible Replacement

REF: Advance Notice of 00S49 Demonstration/Delivery Hold, issued November 16, 2000

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2001 model year Escape vehicles built at the Kansas City Assembly Plant from October 22, 1999 through November 16, 2000.

REASON FOR DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD

In some of the affected vehicles, the windshield wiper linkage may disengage due to a broken ball socket or loose stud rivet, which may result in a sudden and complete loss of windshield wiper function, possibly without advance warning to the driver. The complete loss of wiper function in adverse weather could potentially result in an accident.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must perform the inspection procedure outlined in Attachment III. If the vehicle fails the inspection, then the windshield wiper module assembly (less motor) must be replaced. This must be done on all of the affected vehicles.

Less than 6% of the total involved units in this program are expected to fail inspection. Only these vehicles will require any parts replacement.

If the wiper module passes the inspections as stated in Attachment III, the vehicle may be released or delivered to the customer.

LIMITED PARTS AVAILABILITY

Parts are in limited supply. (See Attachment II for important details).

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT AND OWNER LETTER MAILING

If you have recently sold a vehicle, please contact that owner immediately and provide them a copy of the owner letter and schedule a service date.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

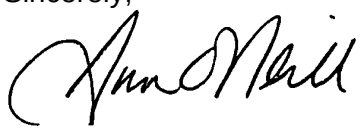
ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD: Safety Recall 00S49
Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles
Windshield Wiper Module Inspection and Possible Replacement

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

If you have recently sold a vehicle, please contact that owner immediately and provide them a copy of the owner letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

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OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will refund owner-paid wiper module repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

For vehicles which fail the inspection, and if parts are not available, Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel which will be at the owner's expense. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area of the recall claim. Follow ESP cost guidelines.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	**Labor Operation**	**Labor Time**
Inspect (4) Wiper Module Assembly Ball Stud Rivets and Ball Sockets (includes tab adjust, if needed)	00S49A	0.4 Hours
Inspect (4) Wiper Module Assembly Ball Stud Rivets and Ball Sockets **AND** Replace Wiper Module Assembly (Includes transfer of original wiper motor)	00S49B	0.6 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

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PARTS REQUIREMENTS

CRITICAL PARTS SUPPLY NOTE – PLEASE READ CAREFULLY

Parts will be in limited supply for several weeks. Therefore, parts will be prioritized for vehicles which Ford records show as sold as of November 16, 2000.

Dealers are to report the results of inspections on all affected units that fail the inspection (for the first 30 days) by calling the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 with the following required information:

- VIN number
- Results of (4) ball stud inspections
- Results of (4) plastic ball socket inspections
- Dealer P&A Code

Based on the inspection results reported, dealers will be advised if the vehicle can be released or if it must be held for repair. Please note that FCS-700 tags will be issued and all replaced parts must be returned to the Warranty Parts Return Center where they will be inspected to assure that only suspect parts are being replaced. The cost of parts not properly inspected or not returned will be charged back to the dealer.

A fair and equitable distribution of parts will be made based on the number of vehicles which fail the inspection and are properly reported to the Recall Hotline. Each Dealer who calls in will receive a shipment of parts for reported units before any dealer receives a second shipment.

No seed stock distribution is planned at this time. No parts will be sent until inspected units are reported to the Recall Hotline.

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PARTS REQUIREMENTS - Continued

Please note that vehicles sold after November 16, 2000 will not receive priority handling for parts.

We urge you to carefully conduct inspections and manage your allocation of parts for this program.

NOTE: All orders must be placed through the Recall Hotline (1-800 325-5621) for the first 30 days, until December 21, 2000. After that date, use the normal order process.

Part Number	Description	Quantity
YL8Z-17566-BA	Windshield Wiper Mounting Arm and Pivot Shaft Assembly (Wiper Module less motor)	1

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50197 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

FCS-700 TAGS

FCS-700 Tags will be issued for each claim involving a wiper module (less motor) replacement. These returned assemblies will be inspected and dealers will be "charged-back" for units that pass inspection criteria. Less than 6% of the wiper module assemblies will require replacement.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

November 2000

00S49

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has determined that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 2001 Escape vehicles.

What the safety issue is …

In some of the affected vehicles, the windshield wiper linkage may disengage when the wipers are in operation. This may result in sudden and complete loss of windshield wiper function, possibly without advance warning to the driver. The complete loss of wiper function in adverse weather could potentially result in an accident.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...

Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for inspection and possible replacement of the windshield wiper module assembly.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 00S49.

If inspection reveals that a new part is required, your dealer will need to order the part. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

Is a rental vehicle available …

If the inspection reveals that a part must be ordered for your vehicle, your dealer has been authorized to provide a rental vehicle at no charge, except for fuel which is at the owner's expense.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

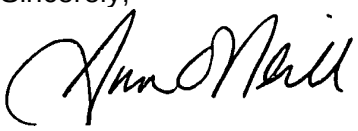
You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline on 1-800-424-9393 or 1-888-327-4863.

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs